



Lionel Messi

Lionel Messi is thought of by many as the finest soccer player of his generation and, by some, as the **best of all time**.

Early life

Lionel was born in **Argentina** in 1987.

As a child he suffered from a medical problem that slowed his growth. However, it was clear Lionel was super talented, and at 12, he was given a tryout by the Spanish club Barcelona.



Barcelona was so impressed by Lionel's skill that the club offered to pay for his medicine.



Messi's nickname is "The Flea" because his quick, darting style makes him a pest to defenders!

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